

sentenced to death and forfeiture of their property. On the application, however, of the clergy and other peers, their lives were granted to them; but they were all banished to different parts of Ireland, with a prohibition from practising as lawyers, but with an annual allowance for their sustenance, and two servants to attend each.

After the death of the Duke of Gloucester in 21 Richard II., the judgments pronounced against them were reversed in the parliament which met in January, 1398; and the subserviency of the lawyers to the ruling power was again exhibited, by the chief justices Walter de Clopton and William Thurning, and Judge Rickhill, confirming, on that occasion, the opinions for which their predecessors had suffered.

The office of chancellor was held by ten individuals during this reign, eight ecclesiastics and two laymen, of whom one held the Seals three times and one twice. It was only vacant for two periods of about two months each, when the duties were performed by temporary keepers.

CHANCELLORS AND KEEPERS.

ADAM DE HOUGHTON, Bishop of St. David's, the chancellor at the close of the last reign, was continued in office by the new king.¹ He held the Seal about sixteen months; when

SIR RICHARD LE SCROPE was appointed on October 29, 1378.² Surrendering the Seal in little more than eight months,

SIMON DE SUDBURY, Archbishop of Canterbury, received it on July 4, 1379.³ He was not chancellor on the day of his brutal murder by Wat Tyler and his associates on June 14, 1381, having resigned his place two days before, in

¹ Rot. Claus. 1 Rich. II., m. 46.

² Ibid. 2 Rich. II., m. 25.

³ Ibid. 3 Rich. II., m. 22.